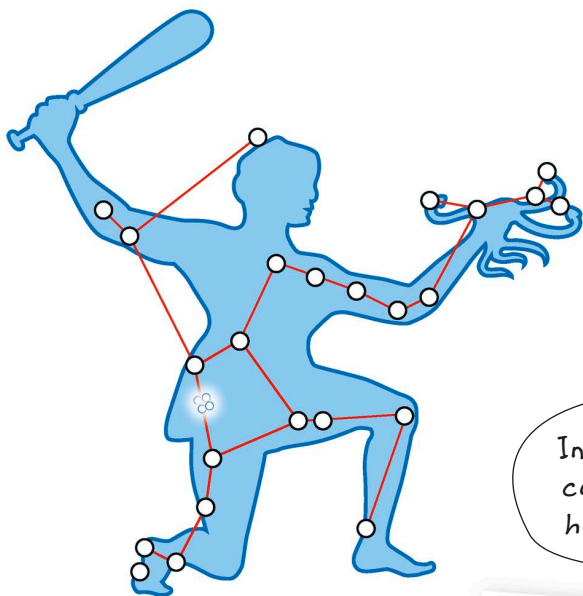




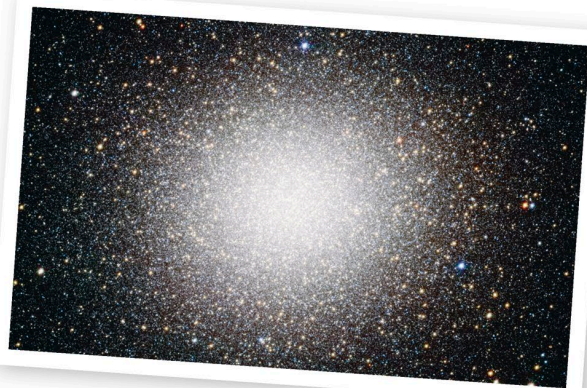
Huge balls of stars

Globular clusters are ball-shaped groups of old stars. They contain hundreds of thousands of stars and look like hazy patches of light in our sky. You can find Hercules between the constellations of the Lyre and the Northern Crown.

In the northern sky, the constellation of Hercules has a bright globular cluster.

Brilliant bunch

The brightest globular cluster in the sky is in the constellation of the Centaur in the southern sky (see p.23). It looks like a hazy patch of light. However, you can see some of its stars with binoculars.



Planetary nebulae

Fuzzy objects such as the Ring Nebula are called planetary nebulae, but they have nothing to do with planets. They are shells of gas blown off by old and dying giant stars.